DocuFire Institutional Edition

Setup guide for departments, agencies, and municipalities · September 2026

DocuFire Institutional Edition is the same DocuFire fire-investigation app, delivered as a **custom app through Apple Business Manager** instead of the public App Store. Your department buys it on a purchase order from DocuFire LLC, and your IT team deploys it to investigators' iPads the same way they deploy any managed app. There is no subscription, no in-app purchase, and no per-user sign-up with DocuFire.

WHAT YOU NEED

An Apple Business Manager account. Free, at `business.apple.com`. Municipalities can use Apple Business Manager or Apple School Manager. Enrollment is verified by Apple and usually takes a few business days. In the U.S. a federal tax ID is enough; a D-U-N-S number is no longer required.

Something to install it with. Custom apps don't appear in the App Store on the iPad; your IT team installs them. If your department already manages its iPads with a tool like Jamf, Intune, Mosyle, or Kandji, that tool does it in a few clicks. If not, a free Apple program called Apple Configurator, run on any Mac with the iPad plugged in by cable, does the same job for a handful of devices.

THE PROCESS

STEP	WHO	WHAT HAPPENS
1	YOU	Find your **Apple Business Manager Organization ID**: sign in to business.apple.com, click your name (bottom left or top right), then *Preferences*. The Organization ID is on that page. Send it to DocuFire with your purchase order or quote request at **support@docufire.app**, along with the number of iPads.
2	DOCUFIRE	We invoice **$169.99 per iPad, per year** — the same price as the individual App Store subscription, no volume markup. All billing is directly between your department and DocuFire LLC. Nothing is charged through Apple.
3	DOCUFIRE	When the PO is in hand, we add your Organization ID to the app's private distribution list in App Store Connect. Within about an hour, DocuFire Institutional Edition appears in your organization's Apple Business Manager store.
4	YOUR IT	In Apple Business Manager: *Apps & Services → Apps & Books → View Store → Custom Apps*. Open DocuFire Institutional Edition, choose *Managed* licenses, assign them to your location, enter the number of iPads,

		and click *Get*. The price shows as $0.00 because you've already purchased through DocuFire.
5	**YOUR IT**	Install the app on investigators' iPads with your device-management tool, exactly like any other managed app. With Apple Configurator, connect the iPad by cable and add the app from your Apps & Books purchases.
6	**INVESTIGATORS**	Open DocuFire on the iPad and sign in with their Apple ID when iCloud asks. Each investigator's cases are stored in their own iCloud account and sync to their own devices, including the DocuFire web portal at **portal.docufire.app** for desktop report writing.

GOOD TO KNOW

Updates are automatic. New versions reach your iPads through the same license. There is nothing to re-purchase.

Case data stays with the investigator. DocuFire syncs through each user's private iCloud. Your department's Apple Business Manager account never holds case data, and DocuFire LLC has no access to it. If several investigators share one Apple ID on pooled devices, they share one case list; each case carries a Lead Investigator field so it's still clear who owns what.

Seat counts. The number of licenses you take in Apple Business Manager should match the iPads on your purchase order. Adding iPads later is a quick email to DocuFire; they are invoiced at $169.99 each, prorated to your renewal date.

Adding a department later. Each organization that buys DocuFire Institutional Edition sees it in its own Apple Business Manager store, so multi-agency arrangements work naturally: each agency sends its own Organization ID.

DocuFire LLC · New Paltz, NY · support@docufire.app · docufire.app/agencies.html
Roger Thorpe reads and answers every message himself.